Stellar Cyber 6.6.0s is now live! Discover all the updates in the release notes!

Configuring Authentication

Stellar Cyber supports **Local** or **SSO** (Single Sign-On) authentication. With local authentication, you log in directly to the Stellar Cyber Platform, and your user credentials are managed locally within the platform. With SSO authentication, you log in through an external IdP (Identity Provider), which authenticates you and relays the login to Stellar Cyber. For either authentication model, you specify whether two-factor authentication (2FA) is **Off**, **Optional**, or **Mandatory**. Use the procedures in this section to define your Stellar Cyber global authentication strategy.

- Configuring Local Authentication
- Configuring SSO Authentication

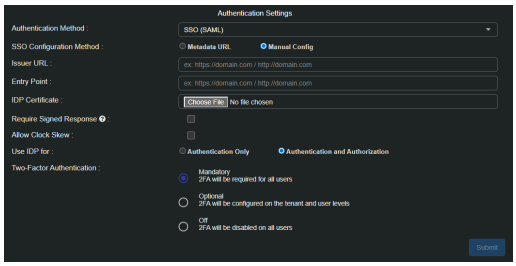
Note the following:

- You can separately customize the authentication strategy for individual tenants in **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Tenants**.
- You can specify 2FA for specific tenants in **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Tenants**, and for specific users in their User Profile.
- **For Authentication Only SSO**: First, manually add all users on the Stellar Cyber Platform. After this manual entry, users can log in with SSO. Use the list of User Principal Names that you saved.
- **For Authentication & Authorization SSO**: Configure all users through the IdP.
- **For Local access (bypass) when SSO is enabled**: If Stellar Cyber loses connectivity with your IdP, users configured for SSO cannot log in. As a preventive bypass method, manually create a new user in the Stellar Cyber Platform with root scope and with a valid email address that has "`+admin`" appended to a valid user name, as follows: `<user>+admin@yourorganization.com` (`joe+admin@yourorganization.com`). The user you create must be able to receive a password reset email at `<user>@yourorganization.com`. This email alias is what Stellar Cyber uses to permit the bypass of an SSO for a local login. After you create this separate user account, the user can log in two ways:
    - An SSO user with `<user>@yourorganization.com`

      or

- A local user at `https://your.stellar.cyber.address/login` using `<user>+admin@yourorganization.com`

If SSO is configured, it's recommended to keep an active administrative account in the Stellar Cyber user management.



Configuring Local Authentication

If you select **Local** authentication, you can still opt to configure two-factor authentication (2FA), which allows you to set whether 2FA is required at all, or optionally specify 2FA as being required at the user/tenant level.

You can override the global authentication settings on a per-tenant basis. Refer to **Managing Tenants** Tenant-level authentication settings affect how tenant-level users authenticate themselves, but they don't affect partner authentication. Regardless of the authentication settings of tenants in their tenant group, partners use the same authentication method as root-level users.

1. Log in to the Stellar Cyber user interface (UI) as a root user with super admin privileges and select **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Settings**.
2. In the **Authentication Settings** section, choose **Local** for **Authentication Method**.
3. Choose a **2FA** method.
    - **Off**: If you choose this option, Stellar Cyber user accounts are not offered a 2FA option.
    - **Mandatory:** If you choose this option, all users for every tenant are required to use 2FA when logging in to Stellar Cyber.
    - **Optional**: If you choose this option:
        - The 2FA option can be customized for individual tenants under **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Tenants**.
        - Individual users can choose to enable 2FA under their **User Profile**, accessed from the top menu of the Stellar Cyber UI.
        - You can enforce 2FA for specific users under **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Users** when adding or editing a user

- The overall Global Settings for 2FA affect authentication for partners and tenant users. For example, if 2FA is **Mandatory**, all users must use 2FA.

- Enabling 2FA here is independent of what you have configured on your SSO service. Enabling it here causes a separate 2FA prompt to be displayed upon logging in to Stellar Cyber.
- The 2FA page from Stellar Cyber refers to use of Google Authenticator, but other authenticator applications also work.

Configuring SSO Authentication

SSO authentication logs you in to Stellar Cyber automatically, using the IdP provider you configured. The first time you log in, your SSO login appears. After you log in to your SSO service, the SSO automatically logs you in to Stellar Cyber the next time you access the page (assuming you are logged in to the SSO service). To log out of Stellar Cyber, log out of your SSO.

You can override the global authentication settings on a per-tenant basis. Refer to **Managing Tenants** Tenant-level authentication settings affect how tenant-level users authenticate themselves, but they don't affect partner authentication. Regardless of the authentication settings of tenants in their tenant group, partners use the same authentication method as root-level users.

Configure your IDP

Stellar Cyber supports several IdPs using SAML 2.0. Stellar Cyber supports use of an IdP for **Authentication** as well as **Authentication and Authorization**.

- ADFS
- Azure AD B2C
- Google
- Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory)
- NetIQ
- Okta
- OneLogin
- Rippling

Use either the general procedure for integrating Stellar Cyber with your IdP or one of the following detailed procedures before you configure Stellar Cyber SSO authentication.

- General IdP Integration
- Azure AD B2C SSO Integration
- Microsoft Entra ID SSO Integration
- Okta SSO Integration
- OneLogin SSO Integration
- Rippling SSO Integration

Enable Users

- **For Authentication Only SSO**: First, manually add all users on the Stellar Cyber Platform. After this manual entry, users can log in with SSO. Use the list of User Principal Names that you saved.
- **For Authentication & Authorization SSO**: Configure all users through the IdP.
- **For Local access (bypass) when SSO is enabled**: If Stellar Cyber loses connectivity with your IdP, users configured for SSO cannot log in. As a preventive bypass method, manually create a new user in the Stellar Cyber Platform with root scope and with a valid email address that has "`+admin`" appended to a valid user name, as follows: `<user>+admin@yourorganization.com` (`joe+admin@yourorganization.com`). The user you create must be able to receive a password reset email at `<user>@yourorganization.com`. This email alias is what Stellar Cyber uses to permit the bypass of an SSO for a local login. After you create this separate user account, the user can log in two ways:
    - An SSO user with `<user>@yourorganization.com`

      or
    - A local user at `https://your.stellar.cyber.address/login` using `<user>+admin@yourorganization.com`



If SSO is configured, it's recommended to keep an active administrative account in the Stellar Cyber user management.

Enabling SSO Globally

A general procedure to configure SSO authentication in Stellar Cyber is provided here:

1. Log in to Stellar Cyber and select **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Settings**.
2. In the **Authentication Settings** section, select **SSO (SAML)** as the **Authentication Method**.
3. Select **Metadata URL** or **Manual Config**:

   If you select **Metadata URL**:

   - **Issuer URL**: If this setting is present, enter the Stellar Cyber URL.
   - **Metadata URL**: Paste the URL you copied from the IdP. The URL must begin with either `https://` or `http://`. Different vendors use different names for the Metadata URL:

Identity Provider	Term for Metadata URL
Active Directory Federation Services	Federation Metadata URL
Microsoft Entra ID	App Federation Metadata URL
Okta	Metadata URL
OneLogin	Issuer URL
Rippling	Metadata URL

   If you select **Manual Config**:

- **Issuer URL**: If this setting is present, enter the Stellar Cyber URL.
- **Entry Point**: te the entry point URL you copied from the IdP.

  You must include **http://** or **https://** before the URLs. Different vendors use different names:

Identity Provider	Term for Entry Point URL
Active Directory Federation Services	SAML Endpoint
Microsoft Entra ID	Login URL or SAML-P Sign-on Endpoint
Okta	Sign on URL
OneLogin	SAML 2.0 Endpoint (HTTP)
Rippling	SAML 2.0 Endpoint (HTTP)

- **IDP Certificate**: Upload the certificate file you downloaded from the IdP.

4. Select **Require Signed Response** only if the IdP requires it.

   Verify whether your IdP requires signed SAML responses. Some IdPs, such as Okta, require them by default. If so, then enable **Require Signed Response** here as well.

5. Select **Allow Clock Skew** to allow for system time differences between Stellar Cyber and your IdP. Authentication messages have an expiration. If the system times on Stellar Cyber and your IdP are not synchronized, the messages might expire before they even get to Stellar Cyber. The result is that users cannot log in, because they cannot authenticate.
6. Choose your IdP setting: **Authentication Only** or **Authentication and Authorization**. Note the following:

   - A Global selection of **Authentication and Authorization** applies to all users (root, partner, and tenant), so the option to change authentication method for a specific tenant is not applicable when the Global method is set to **Authentication and Authorization**. You cannot log in to Tenant SSO when Global SSO is set to **Authentication and Authorization**. If you want to use SSO but also allow local users and tenant override, you must set the Global authentication method either to **Local** or to use the IdP with **Authentication Only**.
   - Although you can customize SSO configuration on a per-tenant basis, the **Authorization** capability is only supported at the global level. Overrides you make at the tenant level are for **Authentication** only, so the toggle for **Authentication and Authorization** is not offered in the tenant editor.
   - The authentication method for partners is the same as that for root users. Any authentication overrides for tenant-level users in a tenant group have no effect on the authentication method for the partners who manage the group.

- Choose **Authentication Only** for Stellar Cyber to authenticate users from your IdP, but manage scope and privilege locally. If you choose this, you must create the user in Stellar Cyber before adding them to your IdP.
- Choose **Authentication and Authorization** for Stellar Cyber to authenticate users from your IdP, along with their scope and level of privilege. You must configure authorization on your IdP before enabling this, otherwise users cannot log in. If you choose this, you do not need to create the user in Stellar Cyber. Stellar Cyber creates the user and assigns scope and privilege based on the information passed from the IdP.

  When Global Settings is configured for **Authentication & Authorization**, the option to **Create** new users manually is hidden because new users must come from the IdP source.

7. Choose a **Two-Factor Authentication** option that matches your IdP configuration:
   - **Off**: If you choose this option, Stellar Cyber user accounts are not offered a 2FA option.
   - **Mandatory**: If you choose this option, all users for every tenant are required to use 2FA when logging in to Stellar Cyber.
   - **Optional**: If you choose this option:
     - The 2FA option can be customized for individual tenants under **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Tenants**.
     - Individual users can choose to enable 2FA under their **User Profile** in the Stellar Cyber UI.
     - You can enforce 2FA for specific users under **System | ORGANIZATION MANAGEMENT | Users** when adding or editing a user

     - The overall Global Settings for 2FA affect authentication for partners and tenant users. For example, if 2FA is **Mandatory**, all users must use 2FA.
     - Enabling 2FA here is independent of what you have configured on your SSO service. Enabling it here causes a separate 2FA prompt to be displayed upon logging in to Stellar Cyber.
     - The 2FA page from Stellar Cyber refers to use of Google Authenticator, but other authenticator applications also work.
8. Review your settings and then **Submit** them.

Stellar Cyber logs all users out (including you) and restarts. When it restarts, it begins using SSO.

If Stellar Cyber loses connectivity with your IdP, users cannot log in. However, the root admin user must always authenticate locally, so can log in from `https://your.Stellar`

Cyber.address/login.



Stellar Cyber version 6.6.0s

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